

Jens Laufer

Forward Deployed Engineer — autonomous AI agents and the harness that makes them reliable

Harness & Agentic Engineering · Forward Deployed · Python · LLM agents / MCP · RAG · Enterprise integration · Java / Spring Boot · Vue 3 · Docker

~29 years of software engineering (freelance since 1997), a second track in data science and machine learning — and since late 2025 harness and agentic engineering: the scaffolding around an LLM that turns a language model into a system you can leave running. Complex projects delivered agile and test-driven, always close to the client.

AVAILABLE from 15 September 2026	WORKS worldwide	REMOTE SHARE 95 % 5 % on-site
HOURLY RATE €100/h on-site €90/h remote · excl. VAT	BASED IN Karlstein am Main Germany	

FOCUS

~29 years of software engineering (since 1997), freelance throughout.

Java/Spring Boot microservices with Vue.js and React front-ends — end-to-end with Docker, Kubernetes and GitLab CI.

Strictly test-driven (TDD, JUnit, Mockito, Playwright/Selenium).

Second track in data science and machine learning — Udacity ML Engineer & Data Analyst, Kaggle, writer at Towards Data Science.

Broad industry exposure: banking/finance, insurance, automotive, telecommunications, travel, industry, retail, marketing and startups.

ROLES

- Full-stack engineering
- Solution design
- Backend engineering
- DevOps
- Build & configuration management
- Data analysis
- Prototyping
- Machine learning
- Jenkins plugin development
- Maven plugin development

SKILLS

DEVOPS / CLOUD

- Docker
- Kubernetes
- Rancher
- GitLab CI
- Jenkins
- Maven
- Grunt
- npm
- Artifactory
- AWS (EC2, S3, SageMaker, VPC)
- Microsoft Azure
- DigitalOcean

LANGUAGES

- Java
- JavaScript
- TypeScript
- Python
- R
- Groovy

MICROSERVICES / BACKEND

Spring Boot

Spring

Spring Data

Spring Integration

Spring Security

OAuth2

Microservices

Feign

Sleuth

Zipkin

Python Eve

Python Flask

Java EE

EJB

API / INTEGRATION

REST

Swagger

OpenAPI

SOAP

Webservices

CXF

XFire

Kafka

ServiceMix

SECURITY / IAM

Keycloak

Spring Security

OAuth2

MACHINE LEARNING

scikit-learn

Keras

DeepLearning4J

CNN

Transfer Learning

Supervised/Unsupervised

k-means

PCA

t-SNE

Reinforcement Learning

OpenAI Gym

Topic Modeling

TOOLING / OTHER

Git

GitLab

Subversion

Jira

Confluence

Kibana

ANTLR

JavaCC

ZXing (QR)

PayPal API

RDF/XML/JSON

SAP (BAPI)

Phonegap

JBoss

Tomcat

FRONTEND

Vue.js

React

AngularJS

GWT

Quasar

HTML

CSS

Bootstrap

PERSISTENCE / DATABASES

MySQL

MongoDB

PostgreSQL

Oracle

Neo4j

JPA

Hibernate

TESTING

JUnit

TDD

Mockito

Selenium

DBUnit

Playwright

DATA SCIENCE

pandas

numpy

dplyr

Jupyter

RMarkdown

ggplot

seaborn

Vega-Lite

A/B Testing

Webscraping

PROJECT HISTORY (SELECTION FROM 2011)

since 12/2025
ongoing

Autonomous AI agent systems — Harness & Agentic Engineering

Solytics GmbH · Remote — AI / SaaS

Harness engineering · Agent engineering · AI system architecture · Full-stack engineering · DevOps

Building and running autonomous LLM agent systems as a **harness engineer** — the engineering around the model, not the model itself. The harness is the product: the **agent loop** and its stop conditions, **tool use over MCP**, layered **memory** (durable facts, running context, session state), **approval gates** for anything irreversible, **quality gates** that must pass before an agent may ship, **observability** over every run, **budget and rate-limit control** with model routing and fallback, plus recovery when a run is killed mid-flight. A local multi-model proxy keeps the whole thing independent of any single provider. Two systems in production: a self-directing AI business partner that plans, writes code, tests and deploys around the clock, and **Fabrik** (fabrikhq.com), a multi-agent platform for autonomous software delivery with parallel worker agents. Event-driven orchestration over Telegram, GitHub and systemd; several AI-built SaaS products shipped end to end.

Claude / Anthropic API

LLM-Agenten

Agent Harness

Multi-Agent-Orchestration

Tool Use / MCP

RAG

Prompt Engineering

Python

FastAPI

Vue 3

Go

Docker

systemd

GitHub Actions

DigitalOcean

SQLite

TDD

TypeScript

07/2022–04/2024

22 months

Front- and back-end, heating cost billing

Brunata · Remote — Industry

Full-stack engineering · Solution design · DevOps

Production server-side services and APIs in Java and Spring Boot: a microservice that parses and generates heating-cost files in the Haweiko-Arge industry format. Designed and built in a microservices architecture with REST interfaces (OpenAPI, Swagger), secured with Spring Security and Keycloak, persisted in MongoDB. Day-to-day GitLab work (version control, merge-request and review workflow); built and maintained the GitLab CI pipelines for automated build and deployment. Worked to DevOps principles, owning build and operation of the services in Docker. Test-driven development (JUnit, Mockito), automated end-to-end tests with Playwright. Front-end development.

Java Spring Boot MongoDB JUnit TDD React Docker GitLab GitLab CI Spring Security Keycloak Mockito OpenAPI Swagger REST Microservices Playwright

01/2022–06/2022

6 months

Payment back-end migration Java EE → Spring Boot

Condor · Remote — Marketing

Backend engineering

Migrated an EJB-based Java EE payment back-end to Spring Boot and shipped it as a Docker container.

Java Java EE JPA Spring Boot MySQL Docker Mockito JUnit TDD

04/2021–11/2021

8 months

Software and data analysis in marketing

DigitalMarketer.com · Remote — Marketing

Full-stack engineering · Prototyping · Solution design · Data analysis

Server-side services in Java and Spring Boot: web-scraping microservices plus microsites (Vue.js, Quasar) with a Spring Boot back-end for calculators, surveys and questionnaire funnels; data analysis in R. Designed and built in a microservices architecture with REST interfaces (OpenAPI, Feign), persisted in PostgreSQL and MongoDB. Day-to-day GitLab work (version control, merge-request and review workflow); built and maintained the GitLab CI pipelines. Worked to DevOps principles, owning build and operation of the services in Docker and Kubernetes. Test-driven development (JUnit, Mockito).

Scrum Spring Boot Docker Kubernetes Microservices REST R Python Java OpenAPI Feign JUnit TDD Mockito Vue.js Quasar MongoDB dplyr GitLab CI GitLab PostgreSQL Python Eve Python Flask DigitalOcean Webscraping A/B Testing Topic Modeling

01/2021–03/2021

3 months

Marketing campaign tooling

DigitalMarketer.com · Remote — Marketing

Full-stack engineering · Solution design

Tools that generate marketing campaigns and publish them to Google Ads and Twitter Ads: Java/Spring Boot microservices with REST interfaces (OpenAPI, Feign), Vue.js/Quasar front-end, storage in AWS S3. Designed and built in a microservices architecture. Day-to-day GitLab work (version control, merge-request and review workflow); built and maintained the GitLab CI pipelines. Worked to DevOps principles, owning build and operation of the services in Docker and Kubernetes. Test-driven development (JUnit, Mockito).

Scrum Spring Boot Docker Kubernetes Microservices REST Java OpenAPI Feign JUnit TDD Mockito Vue.js Quasar AWS S3 GitLab CI GitLab

12/2019–12/2020

13 months

Web-based configuration of telecommunications devices

Deutsche Telekom · Darmstadt/Remote — Telecommunications

DevOps · Build & configuration management · Full-stack engineering

Took over an existing prototype for configuring telecommunications devices over a web interface, developed it further and moved it into production. Production server-side services and APIs in Java and Spring Boot in a microservices architecture (REST, Feign, Spring Data/JPA), Vue.js front-end, secured with Keycloak, persisted in MySQL and MongoDB. Worked to DevOps principles, owning build, operation and monitoring of the services: Docker and Kubernetes (Rancher), logging and tracing via Kibana, Sleuth and Zipkin. Day-to-day GitLab work (version control, merge-request and review workflow); built and maintained the GitLab CI pipelines for automated build and deployment. Test-driven development (JUnit, Mockito).



08/2017–03/2019

20 months

Connected Van — driver's logbook

Volkswagen · Remote — Automotive

Backend engineering

Microservices for vehicle geolocation and a fuel logbook.



07/2015–07/2017

25 months

Invoice management platform (SME)

Deutsche Verrechnungstelle / DVAG · Frankfurt a. Main — Insurance, Finance, Startup

Full-stack engineering

Platform covering the full invoice life cycle (creation, payment, dunning, debt collection); a range of Spring Boot microservices.



02/2015–06/2015

5 months

Invoice management platform (SME) — debt-collection integration

Deutsche Verrechnungstelle / DVAG · Frankfurt a. Main — Insurance, Finance, Startup

Full-stack engineering

Microservice integrating a debt-collection provider



01/2015–02/2015

2 months

Invoice management platform (SME) — OAuth2 service

Deutsche Verrechnungstelle / DVAG · Frankfurt a. Main — Insurance, Finance, Startup

Full-stack engineering

OAuth2 microservice with an administration front-end.

Spring Boot

Docker

Microservices

REST

Java

Maven

Spring Security

OAuth2

MongoDB

AngularJS

Git

09/2014–12/2014

4 months

Invoice management platform (SME) — prototype

Deutsche Verrechnungstelle / DVAG · Frankfurt a. Main — Insurance, Finance, Startup

Full-stack engineering · Solution design · Prototyping · Build & configuration management

Evaluation of microservices and SPA approaches, prototype for an invoice management platform.

Java

JavaScript

HTML

CSS

Spring

Bootstrap

AngularJS

Grunt

npm

Spring Boot

Docker

Kubernetes

Microservices

REST

Maven

Spring Security

MongoDB

Jira

Confluence

Git

05/2011–04/2012

12 months

QR-code based payment solution

Paycoo Ltd. · London — Finance, Startup

Full-stack engineering · Solution design · Build & configuration management

Money transfer between accounts by scanning a QR code; hybrid app (GWT) embedded in native mobile apps for broad platform coverage.

Java

JUnit

TDD

Mockito

GWT

Phonegap

Spring

Spring Security

JPA

REST

ZXing

PayPal API

Maven

AWS EC2

AWS VPC

Jenkins

Artifactory

CONTACT & CREDENTIALS

CONTACT & PROFILES

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KAGGLE	kaggle.com/jenslaufer
PUBLICATION	Towards Data Science — author

EDUCATION

11/1997
Dipl.-Ing. (Univ.) Electrical Engineering (MSc equivalent)
University of Erlangen-Nuremberg
05/1989
Abitur (university entrance qualification)
Gymnasium am Romäusring, Villingen-Schwenningen

CERTIFICATES

12/2018
Machine Learning Engineer Nanodegree
Udacity
Verify →
08/2017
Data Analyst Nanodegree
Udacity
Verify →

